INCH-POUND

MIL-C-44339A
27 November 1990
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-44339
17 June 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CORN, SWEET, CREAM STYLE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cream-style, sweet corn thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8915

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-C-44340 - Can, Tray Pack

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Food Products

United States Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn

United States Standard for Grades of Sweet Corn for Processing

(Copies are available from the Director, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2077, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3330 - Peel Adhesion of Pressure-Sensitive Tape

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400-CD, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Corn. Corn shall be fresh or frozen in accordance with 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2, as applicable. The moisture content of the fresh or frozen corn shall be not less than 68 percent nor more than 71 percent as determined in accordance with the methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Vegetable Products Processed, Paragraph: Solids (Total) in Canned Vegetables.

3.2.1.1 Corn, fresh. The fresh corn shall be of golden (yellow) variety and shall be U.S. No. 2 or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Sweet Corn for Processing.

3.2.1.2 Corn, whole, kernel, individually quick frozen (IQF). The IQF corn kernels shall have been prepared from corn meeting the requirements of 3.2.1.1 and 3.3.1. The IQF corn kernels shall be held for not more than 6 months from the date of freezing to canning.

3.2.2 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.3 Sugar. Sugar shall be white, refined, sucrose, granulated cane or beet or a combination of both and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.4 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified maize food starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. The starch shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress, and under conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Fresh corn preparation. The corn shall be prepared by removing husk and silk; by good sorting, trimming and washing; and by removal of the whole kernels in accordance with good commercial practice. The corn kernels shall be blanched only to the extent necessary to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched corn shall be immediately cooled to the initial temperature of the cooling water and thoroughly drained. The cooled, drained corn shall be handled in a manner to prevent discoloration and used in product preparation or individually quick frozen within 4 hours after blanching.

3.3.1.2 Frozen corn preparation. The frozen corn shall be thawed or tempered only to the degree necessary to accomodate product preparation procedures.

3.3.2 Creamed corn preparation. The required percentage of corn kernels (see 3.3.3) shall be mechanically ground through a comminuter to form a smooth, semi-liquid creamy portion.

3.3.3 Cream style corn preparation. The cream style corn shall be prepared from the following ingredients:

Ingredients	Percent
Corn kernels (not ground)	39.0
Water 1/	32.0
Ground corn	22.0
Sugar	4.3
Starch, modified 2/	1.7
Salt 3/	1.0

1/ The percent of water shall be adjusted appropriately depending on the maturity of the corn used to meet the consistency requirement of the finished product (see 3.6).

2/ The percent of starch shall be adjusted appropriately to meet the consistency requirement of the finished product (see 3.6).

3/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements.

NOTE: The following sauce preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternative procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. (When alternative procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared sauce are still applicable.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

a. The fresh whole kernel corn, ground corn, sugar, salt, and approximately 75 percent of the water shall be heated to 180° to 190°F with proper agitation. When using frozen whole kernel corn, the corn shall be added as a last step to form the final mixture and filled into the tray pack cans within 1 hour after preparation when the 150°F temperature cannot be maintained.

b. A thin slurry shall be prepared from the remaining water and the modified starch using a high speed mixer.

c. The starch slurry shall be added to the corn mixture and the entire contents heated to 190°F and held for approximately 5 minutes.

d. The product shall be maintained in the temperature range of 150° to 180°F and filled into the tray pack cans within 2 hours after preparation.

e. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted with water immediately before filling to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with cream style corn such as to conform to the finished product requirements (see 3.6) and to the following requirements:

a. There shall be a headspace of at least 1/4 inch after filling.

b. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum established by a processing authority and specified in the scheduled process so as to ensure compliance with the finished product requirement (see 3.6h).

c. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 5.0 has been achieved. The filled and sealed thermoprocessed tray pack cans shall show no evidence of can swelling when tested for commercial sterility as specified in 4.5.3.4.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall have a net weight of less than 104 ounces.

f. The finished product shall be U.S. Grade B or better in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn.

g. No individual can shall have a salt content of less than 0.5 percent or greater than 1.5 percent.

h. Filled, sealed, and retorted cans shall show evidence of proper vacuum as determined by concavity of the can lid (see 4.5.6).

i. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged in establishments meeting the requirements of Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 110, "Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing; Packing or Holding Human Food," and the plant sanitation requirements of the appropriate Government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The sample cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The sample cans shall be opened and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3200	8	--	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201 to 35000	13	--	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not grade specified 4/
102	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

3/ Interior of filled and sealed cans shall be examined visually for coating defects during product examination. Suspected rust spots shall be verified by testing in accordance with 4.5.7. Any spot verified as a rust spot shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any scratch or fracture that penetrates through the coating of a can shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ The product shall be U.S. Grade B or better in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Cream Style Corn and inspected in accordance with the provisions of the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables, Processed Products Thereof, and certain other Processed Food Products.

4.5.3.3 Salt content testing. Three filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be individually tested for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. Preparation of the sample shall be as follows. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the salt requirement in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.3.4 Commercial sterility testing. The sample size shall be one filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed tray pack can selected from each retort batch in the lot. The sample cans shall be tested for sterility by incubating the cans at 95° ± 5°F for 10 days. Any evidence of can swelling shall be considered a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with 4.5.4.1. In addition, the following defect shall be classified as a major defect.

Evidence of buffing with an abrasive substance (see 5.1.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.4.1 Can label examination. Labels shall be examined for defects in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4) except that for self-adhering labels the following additional defects shall apply:

Major: Label torn or scratched so as to obliterate any of the markings.

Minor: Air bubbles under label.
Label not properly adhered to can, for example, label raised or peeled back from edges or corners.

4.5.4.2 Label adhesive examination. When self-adhering labels are used, the adhesive shall be tested in accordance with ASTM D 3330.

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closure shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with the can manufacturer's requirement and CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D. Any nonconformance based on observation of can seam teardowns or on record of can seam teardowns shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of any involved product.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be allowed to cool to 75° ± 5°F, held for at least 24 hours after thermoprocessing, and then examined for vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge in the center of the lid along the length of the tray pack. Both ends of the straight edge shall touch the lid at the inside edge of the double seam. There shall be a visible gap between the straight edge and the lid for the entire distance of the label panel. Using a shorter straight edge, the same procedure shall be used across the width, in the center of the tray pack can. One measurement shall be made when examining a ribbed lid; lay the straight edge between the two center ribs along the length of the can. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in a single shift on a single sealing machine. The sample size shall be 50 cans. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Test for rust spots on interior of tray pack cans. Where rust spots are suspected on interior of tray pack cans, the following test shall be performed:

a. Immerse a cotton swab in acetone or methyl ethyl ketone solvent and gently rub suspected spot. Handling of the solvent shall be in strict accordance with the guidelines of the manufacturer's Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS).

b. If suspected spot immediately disappears, it is not a rust spot.

c. If suspected spot remains, continue gently rubbing with the swab resoaked with solvent, and observe for disappearances or retention of spot. Replenish solvent as necessary.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

d. If spot persists, and all but a very thin coating or no coating remains, it will be scored as a rust spot. This can be confirmed further by rubbing with a finger. The rust spot will be felt as a slight bump over the substrate.

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A.

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred and six ounces of food product shall be filled into a tray pack can conforming to MIL-C-44340 and sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The practice of reconditioning tray pack cans by buffing with an abrasive substance shall not be permitted (see 4.5.4). The interior coating of filled and sealed thermoprocessed cans shall be free of rust spots, scratches, or fractures that penetrate through the coating when examined in accordance with 4.5.3.2.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L or HSC-L with an HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1), except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except that the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box, with the first two cans placed with the lids together and the next two cans with the lids together. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). Flute direction of the box liner shall be vertical. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified, except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load, with all courses having the same pattern. Boxes may be stacked by interlocking and reversing each tier, or by columnar stacking with paperboard or fiberboard sheets placed between each tier. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and with the following:

- Official establishment number (for example, EST 38) or a three-letter code identifying the establishment
- Lot number 1/
- Production shift number 1/
- Retort identification number 1/
- Retort cook number 1/

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1/ The lot number shall be expressed as a four digit Julian code. The first digit shall indicate the year of production and the next three digits shall indicate the day of the year (Example, March 19, 1990, would be coded as 0078). The Julian code shall represent the day the product was packaged and processed. Sub-lotting (when used) shall be represented by an alpha character immediately following the four digit Julian code. Following the four digit Julian code and the alpha character (when used), the other required code information shall be printed in the sequence as listed above.

In addition, the name of the product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined as specified in 4.5.4 after preparation of product in accordance with heating instructions. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT IN WATER: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 15 minutes. Avoid overheating (can shows evidence of bulging).

CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

TO HEAT IN OVEN: Either punch several holes in lid of can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place. Place in a 350°F oven 35 - 40 minutes.

WARNING: Do not place unopened can in oven. This may cause the can to burst.

YIELD: For Army Field Feeding, serves 18 portions of 3/4 cup each. For other uses, serves 25 portions of 1/2 cup each.

As an alternate labeling method, a preprinted, self-adhering, 0.002-inch thick, clear polyester label printed with indelible black ink may be used. Self-adhering labels shall be applied after retorting. Pressure-sensitive adhesive shall require no preparation prior to application. Labels shall tack quickly and adhere without curling or breaking. The adhesive shall have a minimum adhesion of 60 ounces per inch width when examined as specified in 4.5.4.2. When self-adhering labels are used, the tray pack cans shall be labeled with the Julian code and a product code prior to retorting.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary marking in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE, UNLESS PALLET RACKS ARE USED.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Level of packing required (see 5.2).
f. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Combat field rations
Operational rations
Shelf stable
Vegetable, yellow

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the change.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8915-0847)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER MIL-C-44339A	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 1990 November 27

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
Corn, Sweet, Cream Style, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-5221	256-5221
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT:	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:33Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.